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The Yale Political Monthly

An Undergraduate Publication

Community Service or Disservice?
Does Dwight Hall Benefit New Haven?

The National Service Corpse
Clinton's Stillborn Attempt to "Reinvigorate Citizenship"

The Rise of the Religious Right
The Holy Crusade Against Secularism

News From Around the World
Foreign Perspectives on the Crisis in Yugoslavia

Entering Our Fifteenth Year of Publication

VOLUME 15, NUMBER 1 ❦ DECEMBER 1993

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The Yale Political Monthly

An Undergraduate Publication

VOLUME 15, NUMBER 1
DECEMBER, 1993

Community Service or Disservice?
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Yale takes pride in its reputation as a school that promotes community service and volunteerism. Is it as effective, however, for outsiders to give to the community as it is for the community to help itself from within?

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In its eagerness to score a quick "win" on the domestic scene, the Clinton Administration has hammered the National Service Act through Congress. As a result of the Administration's haste, the country is likely to get less than it paid for.

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The Christian Right has made inroads into the American political mainstream. What motivates this movement, and why has it succeeded?

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Community Service or Disservice?

4

Amy Kahn

President Kennedy advised in his inaugural address, "Ask not what your country can do for you, but what you can do for your country." In the decades since this goal was set forth, the American people have exhibited an increasing dedication to public service, and helped to refute an older image of the nation as one riddled with apathy and indifference. President Clinton's National Service Act recently brought to the forefront of the public policy debate the need for a society in which people are voluntarily involved with their neighbors and their communities.

It is essential to understand how Yale volunteer programs inevitably differ from permanent, community-sponsored programs

At Yale, many students evince an equally strong desire to be involved in the larger New Haven community. Volunteers, however, often face difficulties resulting from the physical, biographical, and emotional distance that usually exists between students and residents. Although Yale volunteers in New Haven clearly effect beneficial results, many fundamental obstacles hamper their ability to improve both the lives of individual residents in the short term and the welfare of the community in the long term.

Before examining the present condition and future potential of Yale volunteerism, however, it is useful to understand how Yale programs inevitably differ from permanent, community-sponsored organizations. Among such community organizations, the Charles D. Smith, Jr. Foundation and Educational Center, located in Bridgeport, Connecticut, stands as one of the most successful and inspiring.

Charles Smith, the New York Knicks' star forward and a Bridgeport native, shows the beneficial influence which a professional athlete can have on youth. In 1989 he converted a run-down library in Bridgeport's violent and drug-ridden East End into a spacious and well-equipped educational facility. Headed by Mr. Smith's mother, Dorothy Kenyattaia, and the Center's director, Debbie Sims, the program provides academic guidance for over 75 children, aged four through seventeen, from within the Bridgeport community. The after-school program supplies the children with help on their homework and schoolwork while creating a safe haven for children whose parents often work during the afternoon. A summer camp at the Center also encourages academic success and advancement while providing physical fitness activities and special field trips.

The Center owns a fleet of Apples and IBM PCs designed to introduce the children to computing at an early age, educating them interactively and technologically. Local leaders provide teenage pregnancy and substance abuse prevention programs. Every Friday, a speaker's bureau invites local, professional role models such as firemen, policemen, and nurses, both male and female, to address the children.

As the conceiver and founder of the Center, Charles Smith involves himself tremendously in the operation of the program. His fame and popularity as an NBA star have undoubtedly attracted a great deal of attention and support for the Center, especially from young boys. According to his mother, Mr. Smith telephones the Center daily throughout the school year to check on the progress of the

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Amy Kahn is a Junior in Silliman and Senior Editor of the YPM.
Sunny Chu, a Freshman in Davenport and Justin Nelson, a Freshman in Berkeley, contributed to the writing and researching of this article.

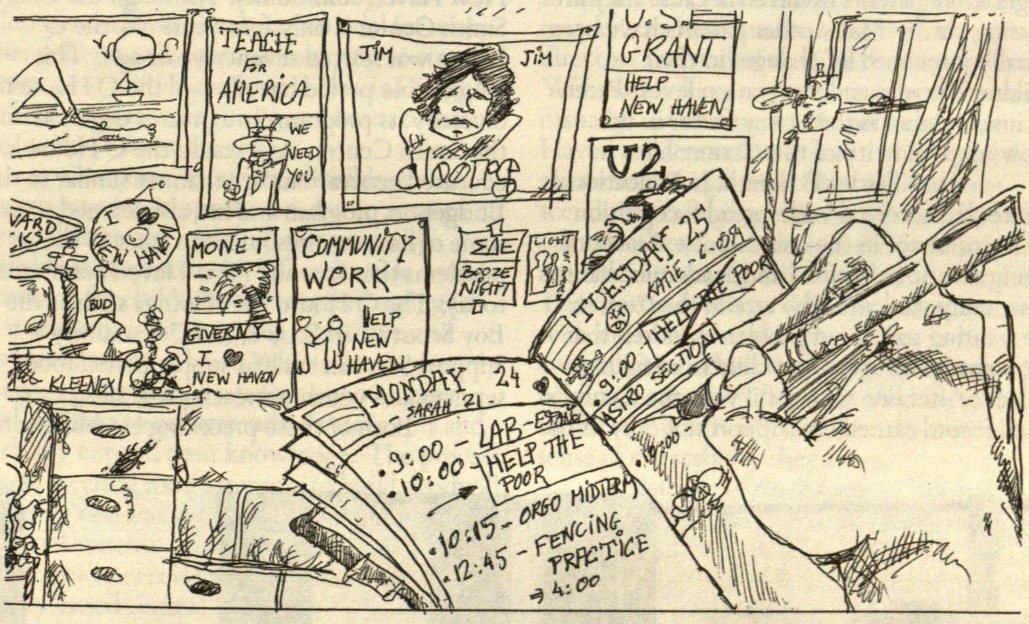
children, occasionally speaking to them personally in an effort to correct individual problems, and he spends summers in Bridgeport, volunteering his time at the Center. In addition to providing substantial financial support, he takes an active role in convincing children to "take the ball out of their hands and put a book in its place."

Although Charles Smith's name has attracted local children to the Center, it is the volunteers and parents who have committed themselves to the Center who ensure the program's long-term success. The Center benefits from a staff of full-time teachers from local schools, as well as many volunteers and aids, who realize the importance of building a rapport with the children. They feel that all-around assistance is necessary. As Debbie Sims insists, "If you can improve the attitude of a child, improvement in her grades will naturally follow." She further elaborates, "In the beginning, these kids weren't trusting of people at all, and we're working on that first, building the trust."[1]

Children who frequent the Center are encouraged to see it as their own, a place in which they are free to explore and develop. In this spirit, children are made an integral part of the creation of rules, with the older children often establishing activities for the younger ones. In addition, there are no areas off limits to the children, no people too important to speak with them. Children often sit in the director's office while she attends to administrative business, just because they crave some special adult attention. Indeed, the director herself adds, "As long as they need us there's no time limit. Here, we make time...we're there for them." Dorothy Kenyattaia often observes how she and Ms. Sims always convey their love to the children. In this way, they become second mothers for many of these children. This open and loving relationship invites elements of trust and security vital to the success of the program.

Ms. Kenyattaia observes that the role of the parents is often most crucial. At the Educational Center, parents play an integral role in daily operations, providing the necessary feedback on whether or not the children are making progress on their homework and especially on their overall attitudes. Unlike volunteer programs in which contact with the parent is de-emphasized, and even at times frowned upon, the Center's ties with the parents are well-established and encouraged.

To involve the parents even further, and give them a look into the daily operations, the Center asks them to volunteer one hour of their time each week. A parent's presence confirms for his child his commitment to education. Parental volunteers may also feel more comfortable with the Center's activities and its staff. Much of this program's power to influence the entire community lies in the parent-administration relationship. The parents frequently have had few ways to participate in their children's education.



Charles Smith takes an active role in convincing children to "take the ball out of their hands and put a book in its place"

The Center also achieves its goal by involving local youth in all aspects of its activities. Previous participants who no longer seek the services of the program are provided with employment opportunities by the Center, which hires several high school students each year to tutor the younger students. This involvement strengthens the rapport between staff and students, as returning participants provide continuity and an understanding that results from previous experience with the Center.

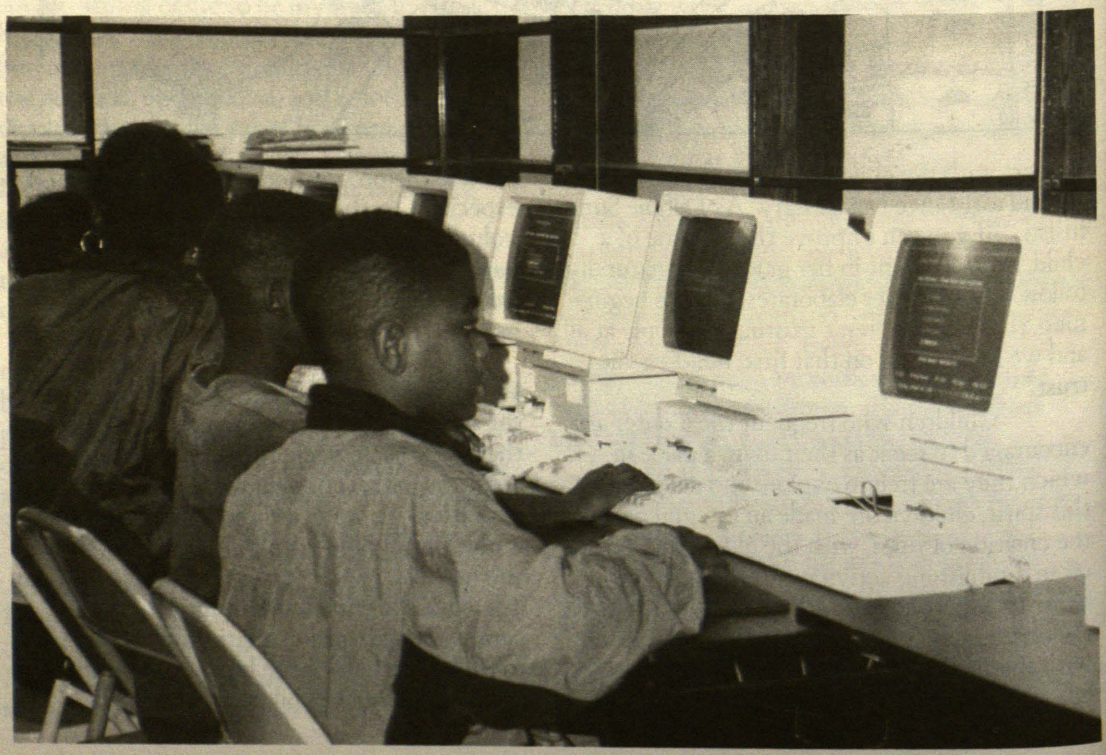
The response of parents to the Bridgeport Center attests to its success. In one letter, a parent praised the Center's summer work, and added, "A goal for future summer camps is to get more parents involved because they are missing out."[2] Many other parents have been equally impressed by changes in their children's grades and motivation level. Parental involvement is thus a key factor in the growing popularity of this Center.

The overall impact of Yale volunteers is more limited than that of true community-based centers

The Charles D. Smith, Jr. Educational Center has received widespread recognition for its influence in the community. Teachers, seeing drastic behavioral and academic changes in so many students who attend the Center, are assuring parents of problem children that the Center will save their child from failing classes. After one successful year, the Center's track record earned the support not only of the city of Bridgeport, but also of Ronald McDonald's Children's Charities and corporations such as Asics footwear. The subsequent financial donations have provided a stable foundation for the operation of the center for years to come.

Although the Charles D. Smith, Jr. Educational Center clearly employs many innovative techniques to improve the welfare of participating children, and has a unique celebrity endorsement, it is by no means the only community based educational center. In fact, similar programs can be found in New Haven's Dixwell Community "Q" House. The Q House has an advantage over Charles Smith's Center in its long history of involvement in the New Haven community. Although the Charles Smith Center is only four years old, the Q House was started seventy years ago. This longer time period has allowed the Q House to diversify its programs to a greater degree than the Smith Center. As a result, the Q House has educated generations in a manner similar to the Bridgeport program and has also learned to use some of its scarce resources to react to the problems that face the New Haven community today. The Q House has offerings such as the Boy Scouts, Girl Scouts, and Community Support Services such as supplemental food services and youth outreach programs.

Both of these preceding establishments



Students in the computer lab at the Charles Smith Educational Center

are community based and address local needs. Although the Charles Smith Center is located in Bridgeport, the Q House is just outside downtown New Haven, making it accessible to approximately twenty Yale students who volunteer there yearly. These students, however, represent but a small portion of the 40% of Yale undergraduates who volunteer each year. The vast majority do so through Yale-organized programs, not community based ones.

Among the Yale-organized volunteers, 75% choose to help by tutoring. Many do so through programs such as DEMOS, TIES, BRANCH, and ROSO which provide a way for Yalies to participate in the education of New Haven children through the public school system.

Dwight Hall, Yale's clearinghouse for volunteer activities, has been a model for many other colleges and universities trying to start community service programs. But, is Dwight Hall set up to benefit the New Haven community or the Yale students?

Of course, local school children who receive tutoring in specific academic areas gain personal attention and skills not normally available at their schools. Yalies provide a vital assistance for children who may be lagging in their academics while giving friendship and support to many others. Yale students certainly receive a great deal of satisfaction in helping local children to understand new concepts and gradually expand their knowledge. The process of volunteering itself attempts to build goodwill between Yale and the community. Despite these potential benefits, however, the overall impact of Yale volunteers is limited, unlike true community-based centers.

Whereas the Charles D. Smith, Jr. Educational Center and the Q House are part of the community itself, Yale students only have four years to have an impact on the New Haven community. During this time, they are enrolled in classes, involved in campus groups and busy preparing for their futures. Making a substantial difference through tutoring, while still focusing on so many other demands, can be a daunting task.

The community centers have a long-term stake in the children's academic success and in the establishment of a more stable learning environment precisely because the staff permanently resides in the area. Children who focus their attention on academics rather than sports and gangs are few in neighborhoods like Bridgeport's East End, and every time Charles Smith has lured a child away from false security into his nurturing Center, he has improved not only that child's life, but also the welfare of the entire community. The Center's after-school teaching staff sees the changes in children's academic and behavioral habits every day in their schools. Parents and teachers can speak to the directors when they see them in church.

Although Yale students may consider New Haven their home for four years, few of them view their stay here as permanent. The average student spends only seven months out of each year in New Haven. Yale students' temporary association with this city makes it easy for the community at large to view them as outsiders. Unlike the families who have frequent and informal contact with the directors and staff of the Charles Smith Center, Yalies rarely have any opportunity to interact casually and spontaneously with the New Haven residents that they tutor. The physical separation of Yale from New Haven transcends the college gates; members of the two communities do not shop in the same stores, nor do they usually attend the same churches. The shortness of any Yalie's presence, coupled with volunteers' virtual invisibility in the communities which they purport to be helping, makes it difficult for children to feel substantial bonds with their tutors or receive a sense of the stability they crave.

Because of these factors, Yale volunteers rarely establish working relationships with the children's parents. Most of the tutoring programs here do not venture beyond the teacher-student relationship; this limits their assistance to an academic level. Often, Yale volunteers find it difficult to involve parents in motivating the students. Many school officials, furthermore, discourage direct contact with family members. Even when groups try to involve the family, their efforts fall shorter than hoped.

Youth Together is one of the few Yale organization that does seek to involve community parents. According to one volunteer, the group called all of the students' parents and personally invited them to an open house. Almost all said that they would attend, yet only half appeared at the event. Why is there such a difference between the involvement of parents in the Bridgeport Center and those connected with the Youth Together program? Many New Haven parents may see the Youth

Is Dwight Hall set up to benefit the New Haven community or the Yale students?

Yale volunteers cannot greatly affect the long term well-being of the New Haven communities which they serve

Together project as a group of outsiders, rather than as an integral part of the community like the Charles Smith Center or the Q House.

Yale students alone may not be able to overcome the barrier that separates them from the greater community. Assistance from the Yale administration might help to ease some of the tensions. President Levin has maintained that he would like to improve the relationship between the University and the city. Most of the administration's efforts, however, seem focused on enhancing the economy of New Haven. This strengthens the economic ties, but overlooks the greater need for community cohesion. Although the goal of economic development is important, it should not be Yale's only focus. Yale is one of the premier educational institutions in the world, but most New Haven residents not affiliated with the university will never set foot inside the school's library system or experience other benefits of this university. This unfortunately perpetuates the "ivory tower" image of the school, reinforcing the partition between volunteers and residents.

Local revitalization must come primarily from within the community itself

Despite these obstacles, Yale students have proven a determination to contribute to their community. Although time is often limited, programs provide varying options for community involvement. Youth Together requires a minimum number of hours each Friday as well as participation in several special events and trips. Other programs, such as TIES, are designed to allow greater flexibility. The existence of differing programs ensures greater participation and commitment from the student body.

Yale students clearly effect substantial and beneficial changes in the lives of the children for whom they are tutors and mentors. Although the extent of their time commitment on both a daily and yearly basis cannot match that of an established community organization, individuals can still have an enormous influence upon the lives of New Haven children. Yale volunteers face great difficulties in affecting the long term well-being of the New Haven communities which they serve, however. Such local revitalization must come primarily from within the community itself, starting perhaps with neighborhood organizations such as Q House and the Charles D. Smith, Jr. Educational Center. These two organizations have united entire communities. Teachers, churches, businesses, and ordinary residents work together with families to provide both education to neighborhood children and hope to the neighborhood itself.

Notes

[1] Fitzpatrick, Jackie. "Neighborhood Is not Forgotten By A Knicks Star." *New York Times.* 27 June 1993.

[2] Letter from Deborah B. Tompkins to the Educational Center. 5 August 1993.

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The National Service Corpse

9

Kirby Lunger

How many recent college graduates searching for a job, or seventeen-year-olds wishing to postpone college for a few years, would turn down a package of a federally guaranteed $4.25 hourly wage, federally guaranteed subsidized health and child care, and a $4,750 stipend towards college expenses–plus almost guaranteed supplemental pay from their actual employer? Not many.

This is the response on which President Bill Clinton depends for the success of the recently passed National and Community Service Trust Act of 1993, which, according to the President, "...expands educational opportunity, rewards individual responsibility, and builds the American community together to tackle common problems." On the contrary, the Service Act creates a barrier to educational opportunity for a greater number of people, in no way rewards individual responsibility, and angers many groups who voted Democratic in the 1992 election.

Most importantly, the Service Act demonstrates yet another Washington blunder. Eager to pass what Will Marshall, president of the Progressive Policy Institute, hailed as "...the first major Clinton policy initiative to be approved," Clinton pushed the Service Act through Congress so that he could claim at least one major policy victory amidst the mire of health care and tax reform issues. The content of the legislation demonstrates the poor planning and hasty execution involved, and once again proves that the President is more interested in image than in substance.

The Service Act aims basically to foster community spirit among America's youth. The Service Act will appropriate $1.5 billion over three years in order to enable up to 100,000 students to earn tuition for college or vocational school (approximately $4,750 per year). In exchange for two years of community service, student volunteers will receive this $4,750 stipend, minimum wage (at least) for their hours spent working, and health and child care benefits. The issue, then, for college students, is how this measure can help or harm them.

The Service Act creates a barrier to educational opportunity for a great number of people and in no way rewards individual responsibility

The most poorly designed portion of this legislation is the purported claim of "expanded educational opportunity." Approximately 16 million students attend post-secondary education programs in the US. Yet only 25,000 students are projected to work for the Service Act program in 1994, and the maximum quota set for the group of student volunteers is 100,000 individuals by 1997. The proposed 1997 quota does not even provide funds to 1 percent of the students participating in post-secondary education programs. Contrast these figures to the Pell Grant and Guaranteed Student Loan Program. GSLP provides aid from the federal government to 3.9 million students, and Pell gives grants to roughly 2.5 million more. These loan and grant programs will cost the taxpayers $4,181 per student in 1993, whereas the Clinton plan will cost $22,677 per student worker per year– in other words, approximately $45,000 for two years worth of service.

Spending for the Service Act has been authorized at a time when the Pell Grant program is maintaining a $2 billion dollar deficit and faces cuts along with a number of other student aid programs. For good measure,

The content of the legislation once again proves that the President is more interested in image than in substance

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Kirby Lunger is a Junior in Ezra Stiles and General Manager of the YPM.

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Requiring or paying for community service fails to engender any proper understanding of citizenship

the salary and benefits earned while "volunteering" in Clinton's service program will not count as income towards determining need for resources such as Pell Grants, welfare benefits, or Medicaid–all with a non-taxable salary! This means that participants in the new Clinton program who rely on welfare will in effect receive double welfare benefits. Not only will these "volunteers" enjoy unemployment benefits, but they will also earn a paycheck through the Clinton program. The Service Act, therefore, will direct precious, limited resources which could be available to federal loan and grant programs away from what is most relevant–helping needy students who could not otherwise pay for college or vocational school.

More irksome to students who already volunteer (for free) and work to make ends meet, the Act does not "reward individual responsibility," as the President so fondly claims. The legislation does not contain any provisions regarding the skill level of individuals who can apply. The "service jobs" offered present more of a financial reward and comfort than can be found in many other entry-level jobs in the private sector. Moreover, the type of work which will probably be available to students who choose to volunteer generally does not provide the skills that prepare individuals to participate in the work force once they leave the program. The purpose of a "national volunteer program" might be better served if the participating students finish college or are employed for a few years before they join, so that they have concrete skills to offer to volunteer organizations in exchange for a paycheck. Clinton's idealism has led him to misdefine "individual responsibility," for he pays little heed to the effect that unskilled volunteers will have on the groups that they are trying to help.

President Clinton's idealism is shared by backers of the legislation, including Senator Harris Wofford, a Pennsylvania Democrat who has also vociferously supported his state's numerous community service programs. These programs include a precedent-setting "volunteer requirement" in a few public high schools. Senator Wofford declared, "With the National Service Act...we will reinvent government, not by more government but by reinvigorating citizenship and igniting the power of citizens to improve their communities and to serve the common good."[1]

Senator Wofford's support of the National Service Act has linked the federal program with discussions of mandatory volunteerism, an effort which two Pennsylvania public high schools have led, and to which the passage of the National Service Act has given support. The schools, located in Bethlehem, have compelled their students to "volunteer" in the community for sixty hours in order to receive their high school diplomas. Robert Thompson, a local school board member in Bethlehem and a supporter of the volunteer requirement, spoke of the program using arguments similar to those that Wofford used in support of the National Service Act: "I believe we need to teach them that it is not just their privilege to volunteer if they feel so inclined, but that as citizens of a democracy they have the responsibility to contribute something of their talent toward the welfare of the whole, to return to the community part of all that they have been given by the community."[2] Mr. Thompson rightly argues that citizenship in a democratic society imposes great obligations on individuals. Yet requiring community service, just as paying for community service, fails to

engender any proper understanding of citizenship or community service.

If Clinton, nevertheless, thinks that his self-declared victory will bring in more votes, he might want to review the voting blocs which he has already offended. Many unions, including those of police and teachers, have publicly denounced the President's plan, stating that he is attempting to replace skilled workers with untrained, naive students who will do more harm than good. Clinton has also angered such groups as the American Legion, Disabled American Veterans, and Veterans of Foreign Wars, because the benefits offered to students to perform community service are more comprehensive than those offered to a number of veterans. Not only is this plan a nightmare for college students and a political faux pas with respect to a number of interest groups, but its ambiguous language leaves terrifyingly huge loopholes wide open for pork barrel tactics, as well as provisions to create an entirely new bloated bureaucracy to oversee the program (Where is Al Gore "reinventing government" when we need him?).

The Service Act is to be administered by the newly-created "Corporation for National Service" (CNS), which will subsume both ACTION (an independent government agency which oversees national and community service programs) and the already existing Commission on National and Community Service. The CNS will then administer all of the programs authorized under the National and Community Service Act and the Domestic Volunteer Service Act (including VISTA). The 1993 Service Act includes a provision that in order to receive any type of grant money, states must individually establish their own commissions on national service. Not only does the Service Act create waste at the federal and state level in the form of new bureaucracies, but it also provides a gigantic new opportunity for lawmakers to reward supporters back home.

Students participating in the program, according to the Service Act, will be assigned to programs chosen by the state governments, and these choices will in turn be regulated by the CNS. Within the states, then, bureaucrats will be able to choose which service organizations deserve funding and help–that is, they will be able to give large sums of money and lots of cheap labor to whomever they decide is deserving. The kind of corruption possible in federal volunteer programs is well-docu-

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mented, as The Comprehensive Employment and Training Act of 1973 (CETA) demonstrates. This project, intended as a "block grant" to advance community service, became the vehicle for such projects as a sculpture class in Miami which practiced braille reading on each other's nude bodies.[3]

Finally, no controls exist to limit the growth of the Service act Program. As Clinton cheerfully promised, if there is more student interest than there are existing slots, he will go back to Congress and request more money.[4] The legislation also does not specify the following information: the type of programs which should and should not receive funding, the nature of the tasks student workers will perform, and the selection criteria through which to determine eligible students.

The most ludicrous point of the whole scenario is that over 20 other federally-sponsored programs already exist (see chart) which provide many options for college students and

Federal Funds Currently Supporting Community Service

Appropriations in FY 1993 dollars

Program	Target Age	Total Volunteers	Cost to Federal Gov't
1. Commission on National and Community Service	(see below)	(see below)	$75.5 million
Conservation and Youth Service Corps	16–24	15,000 (year round) 4,600 (June–August)	$34.5 million (total)
Serve–America	6–18	(not available)	$16.2 million
Higher Education	18–22	(not available)	$5.2 million
National Service Demonstration Programs	(varies)	(not available)	$20.1 million
Civilian Community Corps	14–24	(not available)	$20 million
Civilian Community Corps Defense Downsizing Projects	(varies)	(not available)	$20 million
2. ACTION	(varies)	500,000	$169.6 million
VISTA	18 and up	4,000	$34.7 million
Student Community Service Program	16–22	12,600	$958,000
Special Volunteer Program	(varies)	10,800	$982,000
VISTA Literacy Corps	18 and up	600	$5 million
3. Peace Corps	18 and up	6,300	$186 million
4. Loan Forgiveness within the Stafford Loan Program	(n/a)	(n/a)	(not funded)
5. Community Service Learning Program	(all ages)	(n/a)	$61.7 million
6. National Health Service Corps	(all ages)	1,030 (in 1992)	$118.7 million
7. Indian Health Service	(all ages)	985	$10.5 million
8. Loan Repayment Authority of the Public Health Service Act	(all ages)	(n/a)	(not funded)
9. Scholarship Authority of the Public Health Service Act	(all ages)	(n/a)	(not funded)
10. National Guard Civilian Youth Opportunities Pilot Program	High School dropouts	(n/a)	$44 million
11. Points of Light Foundation	(all ages)	(n/a)	$5 million
12. HOPE VI	(not known)	(n/a)	$50 million
Total		**at least 556,000**	**approx. 1.5 billion**

Adapted from Heritage Foundation Reports, *23 June 1993.*

others to volunteer. The other programs, which do not have Clinton's package of benefits, are more in line with what volunteerism should be: sacrifice for the benefit of others. It seems that the President has conveniently ignored the fact that these other opportunities exist, to ensure that he can follow in JFK's footsteps with a "new vision" for America.

The President has once again demonstrated his desire for a quick political gain rather than legitimate change. A number of alternatives to Clinton's proposed plan are possible. For example, an "Earth Corps" could be created on the scale of FDR's Civilian Conservation Corps of the 1930s. The Earth Corps would be the "embodiment of [our] generation's challenge,"[5] enabling young adults to help prevent pollution that is already occurring. The money proposed for the Service Act could also simply be allocated to provide additional funds for student loan and grant programs, and to research the cause of the spiraling costs of a post-secondary education over the last 30 years. Everyone seems to forget that the real problem for students stems from these immense costs, and students would not need any type of volunteer, grant, or loan program if the majority of colleges were affordable.

The best alternative to the grave folly of the National and Community Service Trust Act of 1993, however, is merely not to spend the money. One may sympathize with the President that his grand plans for sweeping reforms did not take place in the time he allotted himself to complete them. Clinton's desire, however, quickly to achieve his first "big political coup" should not have translated into a fiasco of disorganization and poor planning which costs taxpayers $1.5 billion. The Republicans have been in control of the White House for the last twelve years, and Clinton faces the responsibility of re-establishing the credibility and strength of the Democratic Party. Passing the Service Act without thinking through its consequences only serves to reinforce the public perception of the Democratic Party as the group of individuals who mismanaged the rescue of the American hostages held in Iran in 1979. Clinton has the duty to do a more thorough job–for the sake of his party, of his Presidency, and (one would hope) of the American people. After all, if this is the best he could do with the National Service Act, how can he be expected to handle the intricacies of the proposed national health care reforms?

Notes

[1] Reuter Transcript Report, 17 June 1993.
[2] Michael Winerip, "Required Volunteerism: School Programs Tested," *The New York Times,* 23 September 1993, p. A16.
[3] James Bovard, "Clinton's Summer Jobs Sham," *The Wall Street Journal,* 5 March 1993.
[4] Mark Pitsch, "Clinton Launches Sales Campaign for Service Plan," *Education Week,* Vol. 12, No. 24 (10 March 1993), p. 1.
[5] Tom Hayden, "Service Charge," *Washington Monthly,* Vol. 25, No. 4 (April 1993), p. 23.

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14 The Rise of the Religious Right

John Turner

Richmond, Virginia: 5 June 1993. He ascended the stage like an avenging angel, passionate and violent with his words. More than 14,000 supporters cheered as he finished each fiery sentence. He blasted the "politics of compromise," feminism, and the secular humanism of American public schools. With this sweeping philippic, Michael P. Farris officially accepted Virginia's Republican nomination for Lieutenant Governor.

Frightening to some and inspiring to others, Farris bears the cross of a large wave that has crashed through politics: the uprising of the Religious Right. In fact, the historically conservative Old Dominion hardly represents an isolated case of this phenomenon. From California to Colorado to New York City, from school boards to Congress, this fundamentalist wave is rising in pressure. The Virginia race, however, offered a unique test case for this movement. There had not been an election of such magnitude for the Christian Right since 1988, when Pat Robertson made a spirited run for the Presidency. To Farris and his supporters, his defeat on 3 November mattered little: Farris had won a moral victory merely by speaking the truth.

Mike Farris is an ordained Baptist minister, but an extremely poor politician. Most of his political woes arose due to his involvement in Mozert *v. Hawkins County School District*, or "Scopes II." In 1986 Farris represented angry parents who refused to have their children read "anti-Christian" literature. As a hired lawyer representing the Concerned Women of America, Farris adamantly defended the rights of Christians in schools and obtained a ruling which sanctioned a separate, "Christian" curriculum: a federal appeals court would later strike down this provision. More importantly, his words from these incidents still haunt him. At moments, Farris claimed that Christians would not have as many rights as "blacks in South Africa" and urged "every born-again Christian to get their [*sic*] children out of public schools."[1] Both his GOP and Democratic opponents gained extensive political mileage out of these statements.

In the context of Virginia politics, however, Farris' views do not seem so extreme. The home-school movement, which believes in a home education taught by parents, represents a powerful force in Republican politics; Farris serves as president of the Home-School Legal Defense Fund. In the last two Presidential elections, George Bush carried Virginia by convincing margins. In the race for the GOP Senate nomination, Oliver L. North leads with a simple majority. Finally, the Christian Coalition and the Moral Majority were both born in Virginia. This is no ordinary state. As one Farris coordinator, Joyce Johnson, explained, Mike Farris "is no Jesus freak." Farris ran "because of his faith that he is right before God." Such sentiments are not rare, especially among Virginia Republicans. Individuals like Farris and Johnson find ready answers to support arguments for their political debate in the Bible.

What sets Virginia apart from the rest of the nation, and why may other states soon follow its example? Many would cite Virginia's plethora of high-profile religious leaders and organizations. Jerry Falwell's Moral Majority, one of the original Christian groups, was founded in Virginia. Although he recently disavowed politics, Falwell figured prominently

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John Turner is a Junior in Ezra Stiles

at the 1992 National Republican convention. At a rally before Virginia delegates, his rhetoric was inflammatory: "I'm not opposed to homosexuals, I'm opposed to the practice. Homosexuality is a moral perversion."[2] The Christian Coalition has assumed a greater role in Virginia politics of late, and helped to bring Pat McSweeney, the state's present GOP Chairman, to power. The most recent state convention only confirmed this group's holding power; under Farris' banner, nearly four thousand delegates voted as a bloc. Pat Robertson, the patriarch of the Christian Coalition, thus wields immense power over the Virginia Republican party.

Despite its Virginian roots, the Christian Coalition has grown into a national power. Its political clout extends to anywhere that "traditional values" are in question. In many cases, this influence comes in the form of money. The rhetoric of the national Christian Coalition does not emulate the extremism of the Virginia Christian Right, however. Ralph Reed, the Executive Director of the Christian Coalition, has attempted to move the group beyond religious issues such as abortion–thereby making it more palatable to mainstream voters. Reed explains that the Christian Coalition takes positions on mainstream issues such as NAFTA because it realizes that "to win at the ballot box and in the court of public opinion...the pro-family movement must speak to the concerns of average voters in the areas of taxes, crime, government waste, health care and financial security."[3] In addition to this pragmatic move, the Christian Coalition plans to use nearly $14,000,000 in direct mail and other techniques to send out its message.

When one compares Reed's Christian Coalition with Farris' charged campaign, the two seem like separate movements. The former depends on both conservative think tanks such as the Heritage Foundation and direct mail; the latter, on grassroots groundswells and church networks. At most, the national version represents a sugar-coated version of the Christian Right—not intended for sensitive voters. In practice, however, the long arms of the Christian conservative movement do not often dwell on the technical aspects of budgets or health care. Virginia does not provide the only region, in which Christian politics deals with moral and religious issues. Despite the moderate attempts by the new Christian Coalition, the driving issues on the local level remain the same. Even Reed, after he laid out the new "mainstream" objectives, emphasized that the Christian Coalition had not abandoned its social agenda.

Many observers simply assume that the Religious Right controlled the 1992 Republican National Convention, and thereby thwarted President Bush's re-election bid. Not only does this curious assumption indict conservative politics itself, but it also takes the blame off Bush's own shoulders. Ironically, on issues such as school choice, the 1992 convention delegates proved more moderate than the Republican Party as a whole. It is erroneous to blame the President's defeat on the Religious Right. Rather, the GOP lost because it failed to reconcile its moderate and conservative factions; one could as easily blame Republican moderates for the 1992 setback.

The Christian Right draws its power not from the national GOP, but from grassroots efforts. A visit by the Religious Right can convert even the sleepiest congressional race into a national media event. Representative David Skaggs had represented his Colorado district for three terms. When came the 1992 election, he had little to fear from Baptist minister Brian Day, his unknown and underfinanced opponent. Aside from a few overdrafts at the House Bank, Skaggs had few political liabilities which would have hindered his re-election. At this juncture, Pat Robertson and the Christian Coalition entered the fray, providing Day with moral and financial support. *The New York Times* then dubbed the contest as "Colorado's Test for the Religious Right."[4] If it had indeed been a test, it was not a fair one. Skaggs outspent Day $673,887 to $93,577 and handily defeated him by 28 percentage points.

This incident may serve as a model for future contests. Brian Day did not ask for help from Pat Robertson. By swooping down into Colorado, the Christian Coalition and Citizens for a Responsible Government converted an otherwise sleepy race to a national symbol. What will keep the Christian Coalition from targeting certain congressional races in the future? Then again, why need one distinguish the Christian Coalition from the myriads of special interest groups in the first place?

Colorado's battle with conservative forces did not stop at this isolated congressional race. Colorado and two other states, Oregon and Maine, all faced anti-homosexual

"To win at the ballot box and in the court of public opinion...the pro-family movement must speak to the concerns of average voters"

initiatives, proposed on grounds of religious morality. Evangelical groups were behind each piece of legislation. To no one's surprise, the Christian Coalition also had a hand in these dealings. Strikingly, all these cases held one trait in common: the Religious Right's intense grassroots dedication. If the possibility presents itself, the Christian Right will attempt to win its case.

Local school boards offer an incredible opportunity for religious conservatives to exert a huge impact on their community, yet to continue their grassroots style. Over the past few years, the Religious Right has slowly gained control of school boards across the country. Matthew Freeman, director of research at People for the American Way, explained, "This movement is gathering steam and will most likely impact hundreds more [*sic*] school boards in the next few years."[5] Gaining control of local education looms high on the pro-family agenda. According to Robert Simonds, more than 3,500 members of his conservative National Association of Christian Educators/Citizens for Excellence in Education won seats last year. In addition, People for the American Way claim that Religious Right candidates won school board seats across twelve states.

Why should the federal government dictate the mores of every local community?

Contrary to popular stereotype, this grassroots movement does not confine itself to a single geographical region. In New York City, the Christian Coalition once again joined battle. It passed out 500,000 voter guides to the city's school board election. These guides rated the candidates on pro-family issues such as school prayer. Ralph Reed claimed that the Coalition had not only increased voter turnout, but had also helped to elect 63 percent of its recommended candidates. In Texas, meanwhile, the Christian-dominated school board of Round Rock recently voted to reinstate prayer at graduation as the first step on its conservative agenda.

The school board of Vista, a San Diego suburb, received nationwide attention for its conservative achievements. After two members of the Christian Right gained seats on the board, the three-person majority instituted a prayer before each meeting. The board subsequently proposed that creationism be taught in addition to evolution. The board saw no conflict by providing equal time to both theories. This not only violated California State Education guidelines for teaching in schools, but could result in a Supreme Court case which would rival the famous Scopes trial. Yet this violation of California state educational guidelines does not necessarily violate the separation of church and state. By teaching creationism alongside evolution, one may merely provide additional cultural perspectives, if the discussion proceeds in appropriate fashion.

Why do the fundamentalists want to introduce creationism in public school classes? There are two arguments that have varying degrees of salience. The Religious Right holds the opinion that the Judeo-Christian tradition remains the foundation of American mores. Another element in struggle between the schools of creationism and evolutionism is the fight over local self-determination. This argument is compelling in its solid grounding in the American political tradition. It is difficult to deny that certain communities in the United States possess distinct mores and traditions that do not exist elsewhere in America. Why should the federal government, assuming that it does not itself convey any sense of mores, dictate the mores of an autonomous community? The Vista schoolboard members were elected democratically, and therefore they represent the educational needs of the community. This federal intervention into community life is both heavy-handed and troublesome. Communities should be able to establish the richness of their own culture. Who can argue against the Christian culture in Vista?

For most, it is difficult to understand the passion and determination of those in the Religious Right. It simply rests on the solid confidence that they alone know the truth as revealed in the Bible. The Bible recognizes the power of family, the evil of debt, and the importance of belief in Jesus Christ. All three are challenged in today's society. Attacks on their beliefs may explain the unmatched fervor of these fundamentalist partisans. For many people outside the movement, this certainty of belief seems strange and alien; many dismiss it out of fear.

Despite this lack of understanding, however, the Religious Right is winning more and more victories. One may offer several explanations for this success. This movement is a backlash against the increasing secularization of American society. The farther that America has moved in this direction, the larger has been the force of the Religious Right. Modern direct-mail and fundraising technology have

helped fundamentalists like Pat Robertson to attract new supporters. This movement also appeals to the basic moralistic sentiments that Jimmy Carter championed, especially clean government and honesty in politics.

As passionate as many fundamentalist Christians are, the great majority are not book-burners or fascists. Most are Christians first; they believe in a religion that provides moral codes for living. This belief itself does not seem so frightening, but no group exists without a radical fringe. The Religious Right has indeed been cursed by a plethora of ill fortune, which culminated in the murder of a doctor of an abortion clinic last year. Yet if such extremist displays can discredit a movement, then the New Left should have perished in the Sixties.

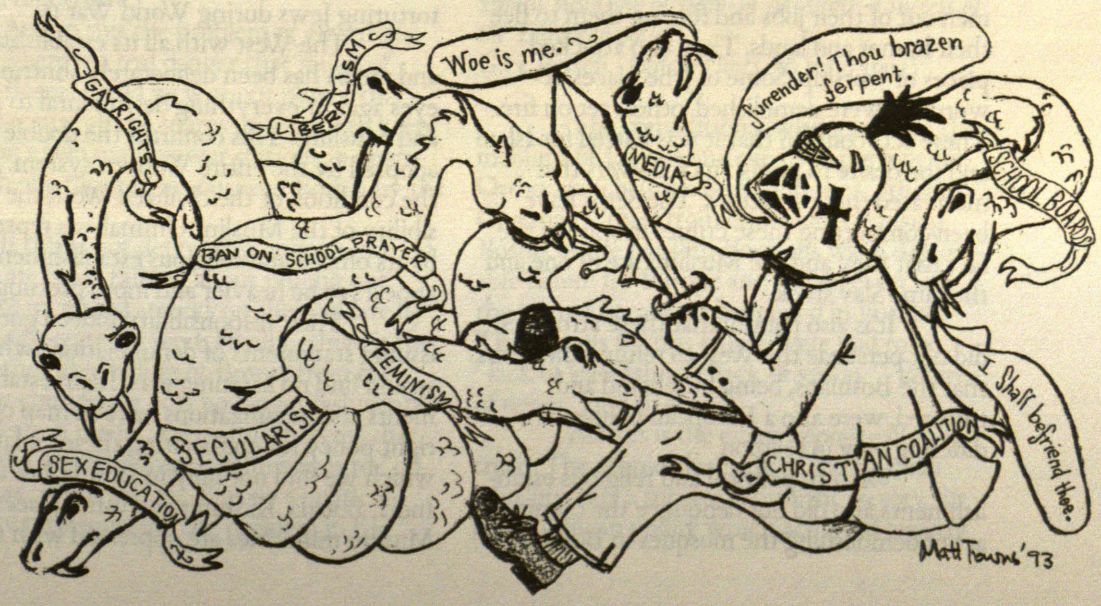
The Religious Right openly challenges the American political mainstream. Its candidates and activists have no reason to hide their views. Many from the left wax profusely about the existence of Christian Right "stealth candidates," who hide their religious views from the public until after the election. If one applied this criterion uniformly, Bill Clinton would emerge as the ultimate "stealth candidate." Did anyone really know how he truly felt about Haiti and homosexuals in the military? Being Christian does not mean that one is obsessed about abortion and creationism. Liberals are ludicrous to demand that these "stealth candidates" only address issues repugnant to the left. How could one run a successful campaign in such a manner?

It often proves difficult to differentiate politicians of the Religious Right from those of the conservative stripe. By "religious right," this article denotes those in political arena who harbor strong, fundamental Christian values. Many conservatives are politicians first and later become "born again" in order to draw in this burgeoning electorate. Ronald Reagan and Pat Buchanan both used Christian language, but neither belong to the Christian Right in spirit. As more Christian conservatives attain office, however, this distinction will become harder to recognize.

The Religious Right continues to grow throughout the nation. It has already gained control of many state GOP organizations, including that of Virginia. If they are to succeed, many Republican candidates must increasingly focus on family and Christian-oriented issues. President Bush, for example, had to re-affirm his pro-life stance in order to keep the Religious Right active. Although many challengers to Clinton would prefer to address economic issues, the Christian Right may ultimately play the role of GOP kingmaker. Indeed, should either Phil Gramm or Jack Kemp garner the support of both moderate and religious constituencies, he may not only secure the Republican nomination, but the Presidency itself.

Notes

[1] *The Washington Post.* 5 August 1993.
[2] *The Washington Post.* 20 August 1993.
[3] *The Washington Post.* 18 July 1993.
[4] *The New York Times.* 23 October 1992.
[5] *The Christian Science Monitor.* 9 August 1993.



News From Around the World

18

Foreign Perspectives on The Crisis in Yugoslavia

Saudi Arabia
Demolition of mosques in Bosnia goes unnoticed.
Dr. Asem Hamdan (*Arab News,* 11 October 1993)

The Serbs have demolished, as reported by Al Hayat, the last two mosques in Banja Luka–a city in northwestern Bosnia, likely to become the capital of the Serbian republic to be formed under the Geneva plan. The city had 16 mosques of historic, archaeological and religious importance. None of them remains now.

History has rarely seen a human tragedy comparable to the one suffered by the people of Bosnia. Nor has it... known a people as savage as the Serbs, so devoid of human feelings, so disdainful of all norms of civilized human behavior.

They were not satisfied with killing the innocent, committing rapes, driving young men out of their jobs and forcing them to flee their homes and lands. They also attacked places of worship. Some of [the places of worship] were demolished, others set on fire. These acts confirm that it was hatred for Islam and the desire to punish its followers that motivated these atrocities. The Serbs have been committing these crimes in spite of the fact that they and the Muslims are of one and the same Slav stock.

It is also painful that these atrocities did not persuade the West to remind the Serbs that the Bosnians, being butchered and tortured, were also a European people, differing only in religion.

Western political and religious establishments also did not denounce the criminal act of demolishing the mosques in Bosnian cities. This should be viewed against the denunciations that had gushed out when a Jewish graveyard in France was dug up by the ultra-rightists. We still remember how the president of France and the members of his government rushed to denounce these acts. A number of demonstrations were taken out through the streets of Paris protesting the act of vandalism.

When a British cemetery in Holland was damaged by neo-Nazis a few months ago, the Western media poured down tears over the stones erected on the graves. It was only the stones that were subjected to humiliation. Then what would have been the situation, had the humiliation gone beyond the commemorative stones to the people buried in the graves? Certainly the matter would have become very serious and the suspects would have been chased, arrested and prosecuted. They might have been even hanged in public as was the fate of everyone suspected of having participated in torturing Jews during World War II.

The West with all its establishments and media has been deliberately shutting its eyes against everything detrimental to Islam and Muslims. This confirms the double standard adopted by the entire Western system. If this is the condition of the civilized West, the responsibility of the Muslim Ummah–as represented by its official and religious establishments–appears to be heavier and more pressing.

Their responsibility indeed goes beyond issuing statements of denunciation...which would find no listening ears. Islam establishments and organizations have to map out the right policy for confronting these violations which we find not only in Bosnia, but also in India, Burma, Kashmir and other places where Muslim minorities are oppressed with no one to

come to their help except God. Indeed He is the best helper and supporter.

Winter of despair
(*Arab News*, 21 October 1993)

In times of war, especially in siege warfare, winter can be a valuable ally. It can also be a terrible enemy. Much depends on which side is the better-supplied. If it is those who are being besieged, winter can mean an end to all their hardships, as the attackers are forced to pull back. If it is the other way around, winter will be a one long ordeal of terror and starvation for the besieged; their chances of surviving through to spring will be limited indeed.

That is the calculation of the forces currently laying siege to various enclaves in Bosnia. They reckon that by spring, the besieged will have to surrender. But there will be no winners in Bosnia this winter. In a country where temperatures drop to as low as [negative twenty-five degrees Centigrade], all the parties there are going to find a season, not of discontent, more of despair and death.

It is not that there is no food. There is. As the aid agencies point out, their stores are full to overflowing. The problem is that the country is now such a patchwork of rival ethnic enclaves that is impossible to move aid [to] where it is needed. The situation around Vitez has become a classic example. At the center is old Vitez, a Muslim enclave of less than a square kilometer. It is entirely surrounded by Croats in the new town and suburbs. They in turn are surrounded by Serbs on three sides and Croats on the fourth. For the aid agencies, it is a logistical nightmare.

Add to this the problem of electricity.

There is a real danger that much of Muslim Bosnia could be without power this winter, because all the spares necessary to keep the region's two main power stations in operation are being blocked in southern Bosnia by the Croats.

If this is not depressing enough, the aid agencies are again talking about pulling out because of increased attacks on them of late by civilians desperate for food. Finally , there is the incomprehensible fading of Bosnia from the European conscience. It is no longer fashionable in the Western media and it almost seems that, [as a result], freed of domestic pressures to "do something" about Bosnia, Europe's political leaders are now ignoring the problem in the hope that it will go away.

It is a deliberate policy. Not for nothing did the British foreign minister, Douglas Hurd, recently accuse the media of "over-coverage" of Bosnia. Such cynicism, however, is rarely voiced for public areas to hear. Nonetheless, the cold reality, voiced quietly in the corridors of power in London, Paris, Madrid and elsewhere is that the various governments want to pull out their peace-keeping forces in the near future unless a peace formula can be found.

Politicians may succeed in their campaign of silence. In these days when the media is the final arbiter of what is and is not news, TV cameras turning their lenses away from any human tragedy will condemn the victims to oblivion. The only thing any one can be sure [of] in such a scenario is that politicians will not be the ones to tap awake human conscience to do the decent thing.

That move will have to come from the ordinary people, for whom conscience is still something that matters. They should not allow Bosnia to fade away. When the snows start and the electricity fails and starvation set in, images of dying Bosnians will again appear on TV screens. Public sentiment will again be aroused and the governments of the world, which have done so little to promote a settlement, will again be forced into action.

But by that time, by the time the ponderous machineries of reluctant states lurch into action, will there be anything to be saved?

Jordan
Ethnic cleansing of Bosnian Muslims–a success of the European policy
G.H. Jansen (*Jordan Times*, 20 June 1993)

The conventional wisdom is that the inability of Europe and the US to prevent the Orthodox Christian Serbs and the Catholic Christian Croats from ethnically cleansing Bosnia of the Muslim Bosnians was a deplorable failure for Europe and the US, especially the former because it happened in Europe. The reasons for this failure were said to be "lack of leadership," "lack of vision," "failure of nerve," and so on.

All this is the exact opposite of the truth. The ethnic cleansing of the Bosnian Muslims was a success, a brilliant victory, for the European policy which achieved exactly

what it was meant to do: to prevent the creation of a Muslim-controlled state in the south-eastern region of Christian Europe. Furthermore, this design has been carried out with such skill and finesse that world public opinion does not even know or guess that this cruel plot has been the mainspring of events in Bosnia, although there has been ample evidence on the ground of the plot being carried out.

The Europeans have worked through sins of omission rather than commission: by not acting instead of acting wrongly, by letting things happen, by not stopping the Serbs and Croats. It is because of this passivity that the master plotters have not been identified since it is the local forces who did the dirty work and have taken the blame.

Yet the negative evidence has been overwhelming. There has been the deliberate, repeated refusal to use force against the Serbs with a whole variety of utterly specious excuses. It was said that aerial bombing would be inaccurate and dangerous and ultimately, ineffective, which did not count when it came to bombing Muslims in Mogadishu. Once troops were put in for humanitarian reasons, they themselves then became an excuse to do nothing about using force for political reasons because, it was argued, that would put them in danger of reprisals.

The reason for the steadfast refusal to lift the arms embargo on Bosnia so that the Muslims could get arms to defend themselves is so specious that it should have given the game, the plot, away. Arming Muslims, it was claimed, would increase casualties. Why then did the allies give arms to the resistance fighters in Europe against the Nazis with their certain knowledge that their attacks would bring brutal reprisals and casualties?

One of the main reasons for western inaction was the fear of casualties and of dead men coming home in body bags. For how could the West and the US explain to the bereaved families that their men had died defending Muslims, those aliens and enemies of the West?

The biggest single piece of evidence of the anti-Muslim plot was the Vance-Owen plan for Bosnia. Serbia would remain intact, Croatia would remain intact, but Muslim-majority-Bosnia would be chopped up into ten pieces.

But suspicions about what has happened are beginning to be aired. US Senator Joseph Biden has asked pointedly whether European reaction to Bosnian events would have been the same, if instead of Christian killing Muslims it had been Muslims killing Christians. A Croatian leader speaking on American television, and identifying himself as a Croat, said fully and frankly that the Christian states of Europe had not wanted a Muslim state in the Balkans. Polite obliquity took over when the Turkish Foreign Minister, Hikmet Cetin, told a NATO meeting on 11 June that if Europe did not do more in Bosnia, critics would say that its inaction was because the Bosnians were Muslims. The Iranians have made the anti-Muslim accusation boldly and openly and the Organisation of Islamic Conference has done so half-heartedly. But who cares what partisan Muslims think or say as long as they do nothing?—which has been the case.

What do the Europeans have against a European Muslim state? It must be said that that objection has an element of neatness. West Asia and North Africa, a large enough area, is Islamic and Europe and North and South America are Christian and each religion should stay in its own area. Isolated religious enclaves, either racial or religious, only cause trouble like the Christian Lebanese in Muslim West Asia and the Christians in northeast India or the Karens in Burma (the Christian Philippines fortunately are offshore islands).

Apart from that general "justification" of European anti-Muslim hostility, there are more specific reasons for it. There is the rooted, atavistic West European fear of Muslim hordes sweeping in from the east. This has been revived by the "invasion" of West European countries by millions of Muslim immigrants—Turks in Germany, Moroccans and Algerians in France, Pakistanis and Bangladeshis in Britain, and these Islamic fifth columns are being radicalised and energised by the force of militant Islam coming out of Iran and other Muslim countries.

It is being conveniently forgotten that militant Islam is itself a reaction to Christian hostility and pressure displayed by such things as support for the intrusive Jewish entity thrust into West Asia and the defence of Salman Rushdie's vulgar and insulting attack on Islam in "The Satanic Verses."

If the British, French and Germans are reacting fearfully against reactive Muslim immigrants in those countries, the Serbs and

Croats have had no reason at all to react against the Bosnian Muslims. These have been not merely quiescent but positively indifferent Muslims, to the point of not identifying themselves as Muslims. The principal motivation of the Croats and Serbs is the ancient memory of what they experienced at Muslim hands during the Ottoman empire, decades and even centuries ago.

One of the main reasons why the anti-Muslim plot has not been recognised for what it is has been because the brave and honest members of the western media have described and denounced the atrocities committed by Serbs and Croats. From which it was mistakenly assumed that the western governments were also against the Serbs and Croats, though that is the exact opposite of the truth. There is all the difference in the world between honest western individuals and aid agencies and the coldly calculating western governments, whose calculations have completely succeeded.

Bankruptcy of values
(*Jordan Times,* 23 June 1993)

Unless the world community contributes men and money to protect UN-designated "safe areas" for Muslims in beleaguered Bosnia-Herzegovina, it might as well tear up Security Council resolutions and arm Muslim forces, French President Francois Mitterand told European Community (EC) leaders Tuesday before they agreed to heed UN demands for more troops to halt Serb aggressions. Since additional EC forces would do little to end the Serb onslaught on the outgunned Muslims, arming the Bosnian Muslims would at least give them a chance to defend themselves.

After a lengthy debate during a two-day summit, the EC leaders, in a bid to demonstrate that they are not abandoning the Muslims, agreed to commit the new troops. But abandoning Muslims is precisely what Europe and indeed the world have been guilty of since the conflict erupted after the collapse of former Yugoslavia.

The many peace attempts that crumbled at Serb intransigence and world inaction speak of one reality: Nothing short of military action would stop Serb attacks and their heinous Nazi-style crimes against a people whom the world has deserted.

But the world, especially Europe, is unwilling to be dragged into a conflict, that, as it festers, has proven the bankruptcy of European political and moral values. One alternative remains: allow the Bosnian Muslims access to arms with which they can defend themselves. If they lose, the world will only be blamed for failing to silence the guns and curbing a conflict in which power once again conquered over justice and human values. Still the world community continues to carry the blame, and the shame, for not helping them or letting them help themselves.

When former US President George Bush proclaimed a new world order at the end of the Gulf war, few of us here took [it] for more than empty rhetoric aimed at justifying a war fought for Western interests–nothing more nothing less. We were right. The world cannot let aggression pay, said the former US commander and chief. But that world too often has been guilty of just that. Bosnia, regrettably, is another case in point.

In Bosnia, aggression is paying, and handsomely so. The Bosnian Muslims Wednesday would be forced to negotiate a settlement drafted by the aggressors. They will have to negotiate the division of their country according to terms dictated by the Serbs and the Croats. What better reward could the aggressors hope to reap?

While aggression is paying, advocates of the new world order sit deafeningly silent.

Greece
The Yugoslav Dilemma
(*Ellopia,* Summer 1993)

The war in former Yugoslavia was not inevitable. The foreign factor has played a decisive role in turning the "urgent" demands of the various ethnic groups for reform into devastating civil strife. Within this framework, [this article] will attempt to outline the Greek opportunities for a peacemaking role in the Balkans.

In the past two years, the lingering question with regard to Greek foreign policy can be formulated in this way: How has it become possible that our traditionally pro-Western leadership continually poses stumbling blocks to EEC policies in the Balkans? Serbs do not miss an opportunity to declare their indebtedness to the Greek people, the Greek government and the Greek political powers. Is this simply the "traditional" Greco-Serbian friendship? Is it the fear of Turkey's

return to the Balkans, through Yugoslavia's disintegration? Quite plainly, Greece's unconventional Balkan policy results from its unconventional role in Balkan politics.

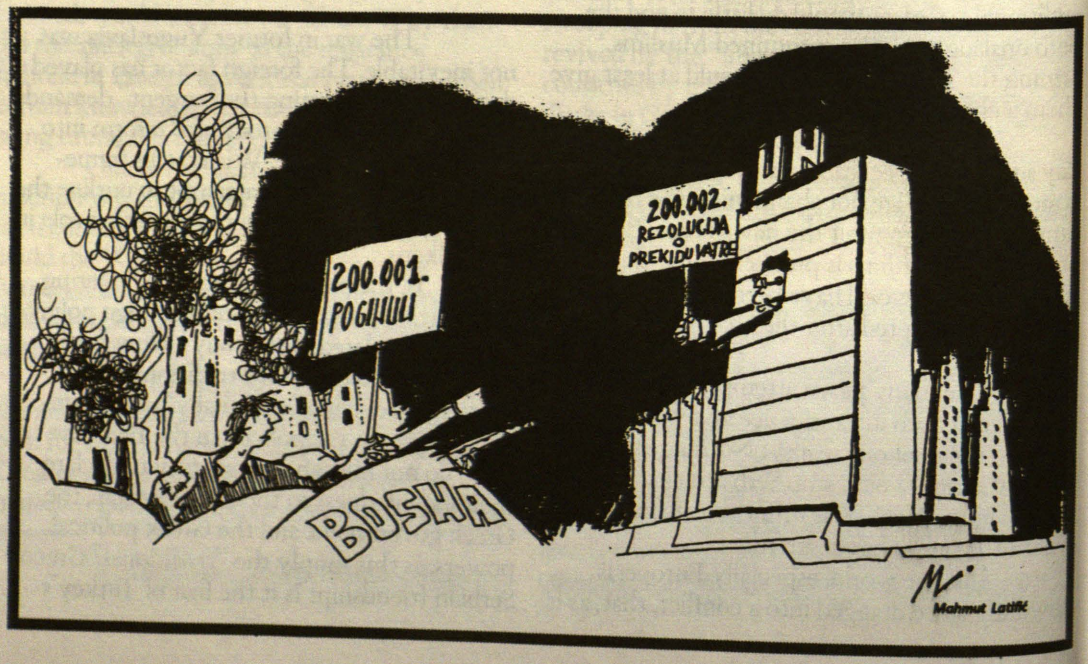
The EEC policy promotes the dismemberment of Serbia, a country that with Greece and Bulgaria forms the vital Balkan Triangle. Such an act evokes numerous bad memories from the past–namely, two world wars. Greece's credibility in Balkan affairs was fortified by the Skopje issue, whereby the UN did not recognize Skopje [seat to the ex-Yugoslav province of Macedonia] upon Greek insistence. This action, as [Greece] had predicted, prevented the expansion of war to ethnic minorities within [the Greek province of] Macedonia.

Many claim that the importance given by Greece to the Skopje issue has hindered the implementation of a general Balkan policy. However, this opinion ignores the fact that foreign policy is not always a matter of purely logical considerations. Public outcry has played a major role in formulating our country's foreign policy in this issue.

There are essentially two policies that can be followed in the Balkans. One will be military and based ultimately on Turkey (after all, it is the only country that has consistently supported military action and has offered to take part in it), and the other one will be diplomatic and centered in [this] country. The policies proposed by the West have reached a cul-de-sac. For [the West] is unable to solve the real problems, and [its policies] have not been formulated with the long-term interest of the Balkan peoples. One the one hand, the new American leadership looks favorably upon the Turkish-based expansion into the Balkans of the Eastern Mediterranean Security Zone because the [Balkan] impasse is going to last for many years, and military intervention will neither be short nor easy. On the other hand, the US seeks a vehicle for Turkey's peaceful disentanglement from the area. It is also important to note the elimination of Italy and its essential displacement from the Balkan political game, as the Italian ruling elite has collapsed under a major moral crisis.

In order for a Balkan policy to be promulgated, Greece must not be forced to become part of an endless adventure. Instead, Greece has to use its good relations with Serbia to influence a settlement. Serbia should be helped to exit the no-win situation of continuing the war. A possible Serbian victory is no guarantee: if such a victory is not used appropriately, it could backfire and reinitiate the conflict.

Greece cannot be the leader of a Balkan policy without considering its own national problems. Such pacifist logic [i.e., disregarding Greece's internal problems] would be detrimental to the interests of [the Greek] state. Greece's Balkan policy will be influenced by the Cyprus, Skopje and Northern Epirus issues. Finally, Greece must not forget its tenuous role of linking the corpse of Yugoslavia to the Western lifeline.



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